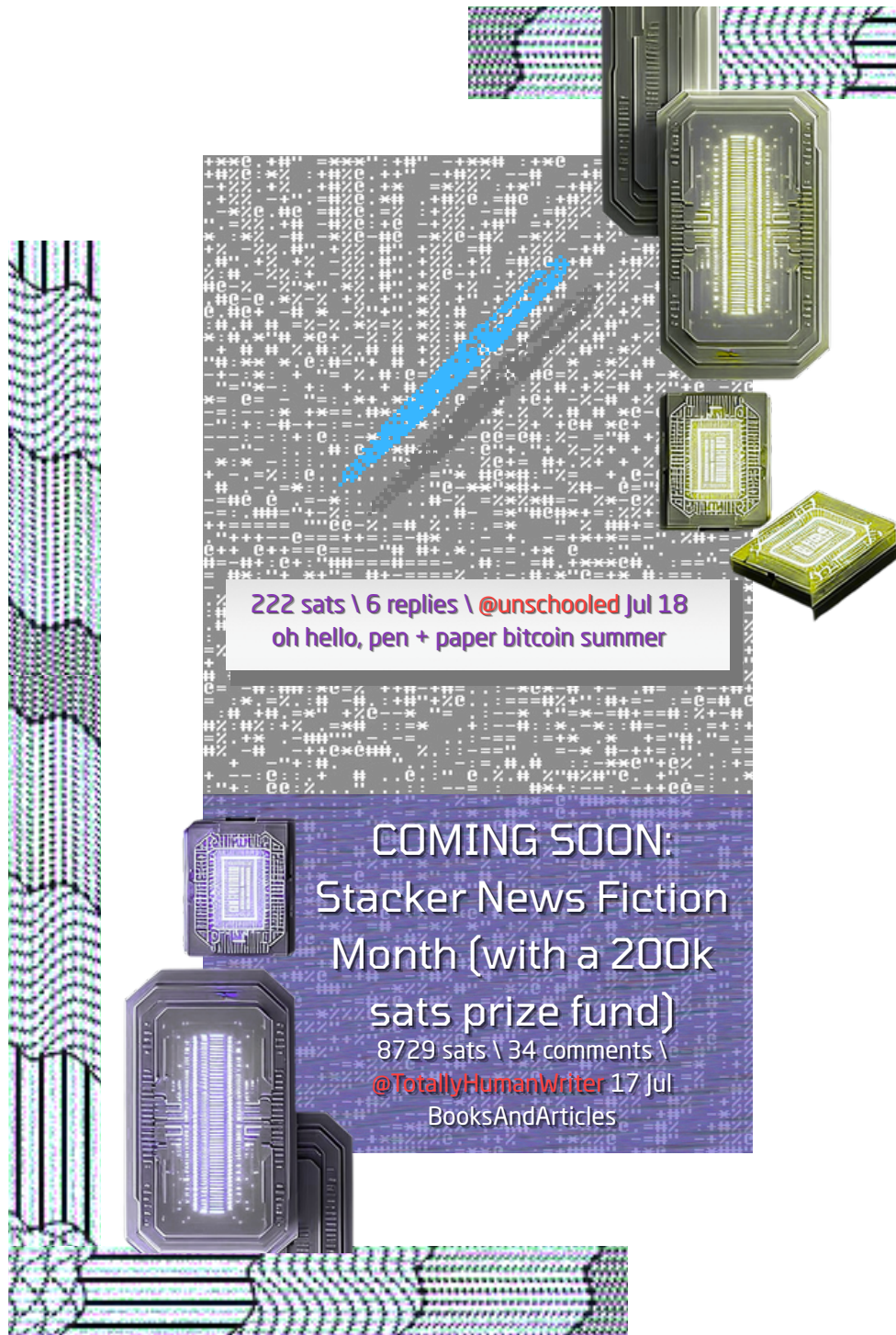
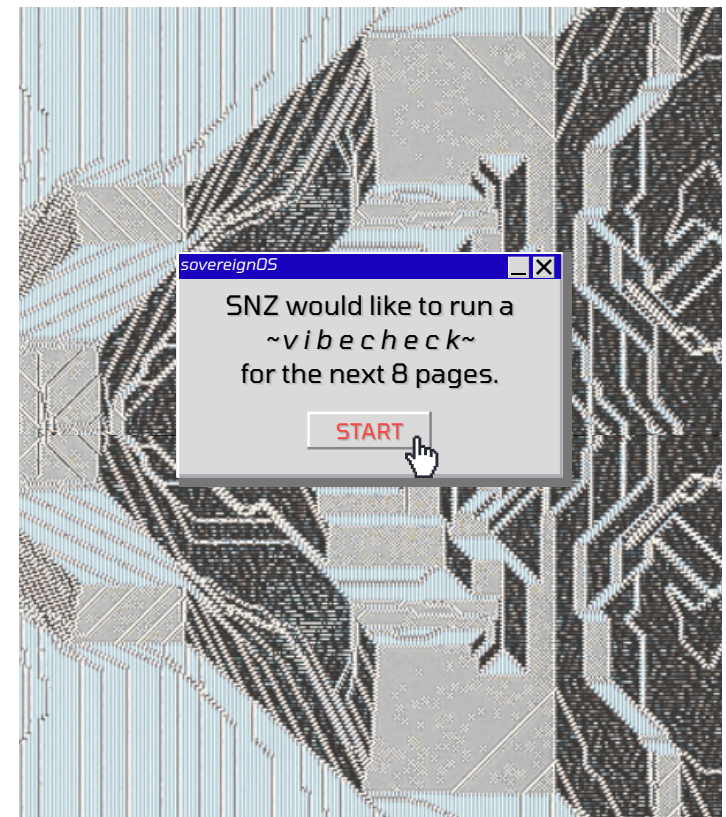




SNZ

stacker.news weekly zine



906 060

July 12 - July 18

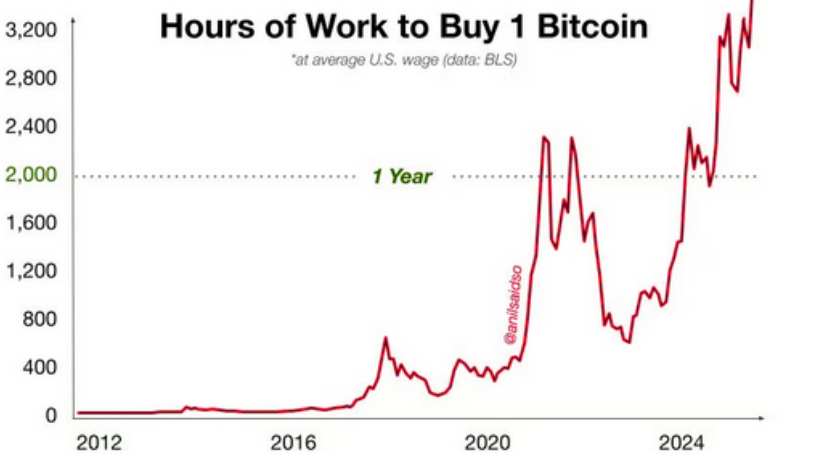
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ISSUE #17



Not Celebrating ATH (Bitcoin Magazine, Oscar Perez)

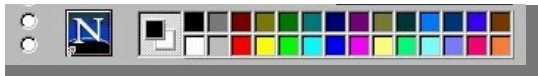
228 sats \ 1 comment \ @denlillaapan 11 Jul bitcoin #1034865



What does it mean for SN to flourish?

6678 sats \ 29 comments \ @elvismercury 8 Feb 2024 meta #418312

SN is eclectic and interesting in a bunch of ways. To me, these are key elements of what it means to flourish, and it's so exciting to be a part of it!



Top Boost

How to Write an Article People Will Read Until the End

1831 sats \ 10k boost \ 25 comments \ @nerd2ninja 11 Jul meta #1035320



What makes a Stacker?

1750 sats \ 52 comments \ @Undisciplined 12 Jul AskSN #1036018



I've asked this question before, but it continues to perplex me.

This community is clearly highly selected and has maintained it's current fairly small size for a long time. And yet, I can't pin down what trait, or combination of traits, makes Stacker News resonate with us when it doesn't with so many others.

Obviously, we are all interested in bitcoin. So are innumerable more people on nostr and X, though, who aren't finding their way here.

We are also mostly people who like learning and having conversations with smart people. However, that's also something many others on alternative platforms claim to want and, despite not finding it, they don't come here.

So, what is it that Darth and Sensei and Blok and the rest of our collection of misfits share that's unique to us?



reply \ 145 sats \ 7 replies \ @Aardvark 12 Jul

For me personally, it's a combination. I have a lot to learn, and there's some really good teachers here. Combined with the fact that I like tedium. Owning a territory and tracking a bunch of shit in a spreadsheet falls right into my wheelhouse as far as hobbies go.

reply \ 232 sats \ 2 replies \ @Scoresby 12 Jul

I still can't get over zapping and getting zapped. No other place on the internet has it so built-in. By far my preferred way to interact with people online. It's the zaps.

144 sats \ 1 reply \ @siggy47 12 Jul

1. Scoresby zapping and getting zapped.
2. For the most part, I don't think we enjoy being assholes online. On other platforms people seem to only be there to fight and insult others.

↳ 36 sats \ 0 replies \ @Undisciplined OP 12 Jul

Even those who do enjoy being assholes here mostly seem to value the substantive content.

reply \ 141 sats \ 3 replies \ @WeAreAllSatoshi 12 Jul

I think in simple terms, we are collectively sick of and/or over the current "system" - whether that be the governmental systems, the fiat money system, the social media system, whatever it means to you.

reply \ 42 sats \ 2 replies \ @HardMoney 12 Jul

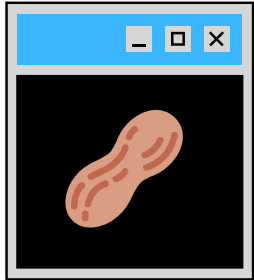
Stacker news kinda sits in between a normie site like Reddit and a super cypherpunk social media like Nostr

Time is scarce so I guess the Nostr folks seem to enjoy that experience more and like the "self custodial" feel to the platform although the UX here is better imo (since it's technically a centralized company with some decentralized features like bringing your own wallet)

People on Reddit probably don't know about it and maybe eventually will migrate once they understand bitcoin better and realize the better product of earning sats for posts vs upvotes

I dropped Cashu e-cash nuts in the saloon for 365 days. Here is what I learned

2668 sats \ 29 comments \ @BlockchainB 14 Jul bitcoin #1039481



My endeavor to drop an e-cash token utilizing the cashu protocol developed by Calle in the stacker news @saloon for one year has ended.

I did this because I think sending tokens via a text string that can be transacted offline is the coolest thing ever. But the problem I had was not having anyone or anywhere to actually use the tokens I minted, so I decided to give them away for free on stacker news!

Below is the Bulleted Summary of my Experience

- Bots quickly ruined the fun. Soon as I would drop a nut it would be redeemed in seconds
- Apple Notes has a minor bug. The day counter wouldn't save! The preview of the note would have the correct day but when I clicked on the note to update the day it counter would go to the day previous. Very odd
- I tried different methods to break the bots but none were effective. Public Note was cool and worked but someone spammed it and the host shut the site down. The meme solution created the nut on their platform so I couldn't tell if the nut was ever redeemed or not. Thus the bots crushed my fun with nuts.
- I tried different wallets during this experiment. The cashu Wallet rugged me when they pushed an update to their PWA. I didn't write down my seed words so those sats were vaporized! (One reason why don't like PWAs!) I restarted with Cashu and things were fine. Once Zeus released its Cashu wallet I moved my nut making talents to Zeus. It's been rocky with Zeus but over time they have made improvements.
- For the mints I only used two. Minibits and OxChat. The OxChat mint stopped working on Zeus for some reason. So a few sats are stuck there. Trying to get help via nostr DMs and Zeus telegram support but both have failed. Minibits mint has worked flawlessly.
- With my daily spam (which caused @Car to block me 😊) a few stackers became interested and spun up some Cashu wallets. But the bots ruined their experience of ever trying to capture a nut but over 365 days of posting I think maybe 5 stackers took notice.

- Trying to defeat the bots I would change a few characters in the long e-cash string but that is when I realized the characters are interchangeable. Makes me think were most of the characters just filler? I didn't dive deep into the overall protocol to figure out how the encoding works but I found it useless to change strings with no impact to redeeming nuts. Thus bots defeated that idea
- I tried the Sovran wallet and it seem to work great but it was in alpha. It was buggy. I deleted the Wallet after a month or so
- I tried to run my own mint using Inbits and that was a disaster. It worked for about a week then it just stopped working. The errors it was giving I didn't understand so I deleted and lost sats
- After the cashu wallet I used the E-Nuts wallet a lot! This was my favorite wallet and part of the reason I did this! About half way through the 365 days the Wallet developer abandoned the project. So when the wallet started to have issues I knew they would never get fixed. So I deleted this Wallet and moved back to cashu wallet.
- To the E-nuts developer thanks for making an awesome e-cash wallet. I wanted to use that wallet to onboard people to e-cash (like I tried to do with my friend in Germany!) but in the end it was all for nothing. But the wallet was iOS native and very cool.

In Summary

It was fun in the beginning but in the end I am glad it's over. After a year of dropping nuts I still don't have a real reason to keep using e-cash. Reasons are:

- No one I know uses it or accepts it for anything.
- I have sats stuck on the OxChat mint.
- The cashu PWA upgrades without notice and rugged me.
- The developer for my favorite wallet (e-nuts) abandoned the project.
- Cashu on Zeus feels more like a gimmick than the natural flow I got with the e-nuts Wallet. To mint a nut the wallet start up takes too long.
- The string can get extremely large! I broke the SN character limit on a few nuts.

That is all I can think of who ever wants the rest of my nuts on Minibits comment below and I can send them to you. Maybe it's just too early for e-cash but I can wait until a killer app or service uses it in a way that sparks my excitement to use it again.



PSA: i got shotgun-KYC scammed by PayWithMoon.com, lost \$1000

3638 sats \ 14 comments \ @conduition 14 Jul bitcoin #1039446

Today I tried using paywithmoon.com reloadable debit cards to pay with Bitcoin online.

I was going to buy some electronics, so I deposited \$1000 worth of BTC. But i wanted to test drive the card first, so I used my Moon X Card to subscribe to a VOIP phone number service. The instant I clicked the "buy" button on that VOIP service website, my Moon account was locked, I see this banner on the website:

A recent transaction was flagged by our compliance system and we have temporarily suspended your account. Please check your email for a message from our compliance team that includes details on how to restore your account.

I received this email telling me to complete KYC verification. . .

. . . So I reach out to their support team. I tell them I don't want to complete KYC verification. After all that's the whole reason i'm using their service in the first place.

In reply, an agent named "Oscar" says:

> Hey there, unfortunately we can not take any actions, including refunds, until verification is completed.

I've sent them a reply pleading to be refunded, but i'm not holding out hope.

Beware of these people. I'd heard their service was reliable, but apparently reputation isn't everything. Maybe they only scam people like this opportunistically and hope not too many of us speak out.

What really confuses me is: **What is there to flag?** It's not like the card number was stolen. The card is pre-loaded with clean bitcoin. Are they concerned i'm financing terrorism somehow by buying a VOIP number? Anyways, that's how I burned \$1000 this afternoon stackers. I hope your day went better than mine.

Remember the cardinal rule of Bitcoin: Not your keys, not your coins.



In case anyone is wondering:

- No, I didn't deposit any "sketchy looking" bitcoins. I deposited coins from a reputable source, no mixers, coinjoins, or instant-exchanges involved.
- I was connected to moon over a VPN when signing up, and was also connected to a VPN when making my VOIP purchase
- I was using a throwaway email address. Maybe this triggered the flag?
If so why wait until *after* i made a purchase to trigger KYC? Why not suspend my account *right away*?



Discussion

reply \ 1042 sats \ 3 replies \ @anon 14 Jul

Hi there, CEO of paywithmoon.com here.

While I don't know the details of your specific case, based on the email in your post the bitcoin you sent to our platform was flagged by Chainalysis.

Can you please reply in the support ticket and reference this post so I can track down your case? If your payment was in fact from a reputable source I would like to personally investigate this further as to why the transaction was flagged.

I understand this is frustrating. We do everything in our power to maximize privacy in our services. Unfortunately, we are bound by regulations and compliance obligations that sometimes limit the services we are able to provide and the customers we can serve, and mandates we use technologies to comply with these rules.

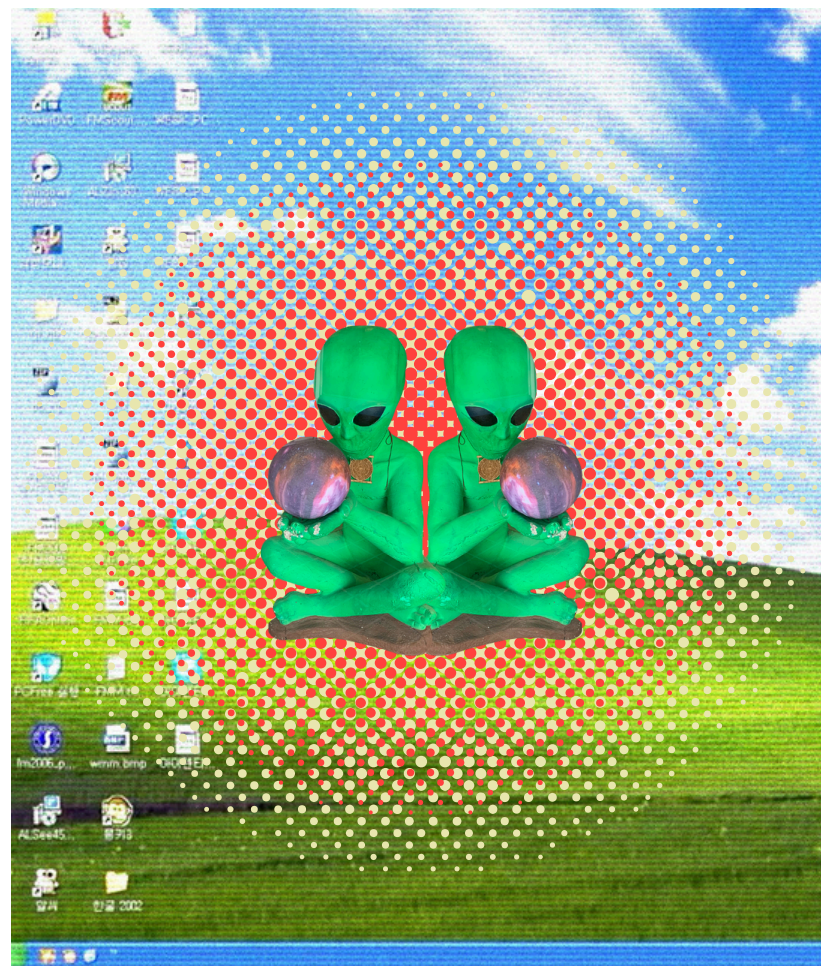
↳ 196 sats \ 0 replies \ @conduition OP 15 Jul
Thanks for posting here. . .

reply \ 105 sats \ 1 reply \ @optimism 14 Jul

Thanks for the warning.

Here's my recommendation:

1. Do the KYC
2. Don't use it, make sure you get the refund
3. Never use their service again
4. Get rid of the refunded utxo - either send it back to wherever you got it from, or start a lightning channel, submarine swap out, keep that swapped utxo.



The Introductory Econ Reading List

3122 sats \ 19 comments \ @Undisciplined 15 Jul econ #1040984

Inspired by @Aardvark's post today, and at @grayruby's encouragement, here's my recommended reading list to have a strong grasp of basic economics.

Leave your favorites in the comments, or just tell me that I left out something important. My aim, though, is to get to the mountain top as quickly and painlessly as possible.

Economics in One Lesson by Henry Hazlitt

This is pretty close to the universal answer to the "Where should I start?" question. Clear and concise, Hazlitt gets right to the point that economics is about tradeoffs and illustrates the idea through several evergreen examples.

Man, Economy, and State by Murray Rothbard

This treatise comprehensively covers the basic concepts of economics (prices, production, supply, demand, etc.). Rothbard is a very clear writer and uses simple graphs and tables to illustrate his points.

Human Action by Ludwig von Mises

From a previous post about Human Action

- > *In my mind, this is the treatise on economics. Nowhere else will you find the underlying philosophical framework laid out so thoroughly. Some people really don't care about the philosophy (including most economists), but I find it fascinating.*

I recommend reading them in this order, with some caveats:

- If you've been hanging around these parts for a while, you can probably skip the first one. It is short, though, and a pleasant read, so you may as well take an afternoon to read it.
- If you're more philosophically inclined, you might just jump straight to Human Action. It covers a lot of the same ground as Rothbard, but generally does so from a more grounded philosophical perspective. Most people seem to find this more challenging though and prefer the more conventional treatment from Rothbard as their introduction.
- Rothbard was Mises' successor, so there are some points where he corrects or refines Mises' arguments. In my suggested order, you get the corrected version first, which is a little awkward.

Live and Let Gift (A post about zines)

2281 sats \ 2 comments \ @pappasbland 17 Jul art #1043353

In the heart of our small town there is a little info booth, a postage stamp of a visitor's center.

People come to the Berkshires in Massachusetts for idyllic summer days surrounded by mountains, lakes, farms, meadows, and cute towns peppered with farm stands, antique shops and top-shelf cultural attractions - you get the idea. The info booth has information for local venues and businesses, arts happenings and farm dinners. People come in and grab a few brochures and magazines and go off and enjoy their time in the Berkshires.



They can also leave the info booth with a piece of artwork.

A few months ago an idea started brewing in my mind, a culmination of reading about the gift economy in The Serviceberry by Robin Wall Kimmerer and my experience as a member of Seth Werkheiser's excellent SOCIAL MEDIA ESCAPE CLUB (<https://socialmediaescapeclub.substack.com>) and the liberating idea that anyone can publish a zine as evidenced by the variety of work (both polished and unpolished) curated by Jen Mayer at Zinestack (<https://zinestack.substack.com>).

We had a printer, we had paper, and I had had pent-up frustration with the digital landscape - it was time to make a zine and disperse it in our local community.

It was liberating to make something purely experimental, almost speculative, like a rough draft that I was ok with people seeing. Would people pick up a zine? Would they be curious about our work?



@Picture Room

The first zines buckled in the changing humidity and weren't picked up by anyone. Undeterred, I decided to take a risk and try something slightly rebellious with my artwork. What if I just gave it away? I pivoted to putting the zines in protective sleeves with the surprise gift of a signed 4x6" print and let me tell you, those zines have been flying off the shelf. I'd guess maybe 65 zines have been taken in the last month, that means 65 of my photographs are out there in new homes, and we know of at least one big print purchased from us because someone was impressed with our zine in the info booth.



This zine + artwork combination is about as opposite of an Instagram post as you can get. It's hyperlocal rather than broadcasted to the whole world. It is tangible instead of existing in the digital ether. There are no likes, no comments, either people pick them up or they don't. And if they pick them up then we have made a connection. My art exists in their world, maybe in a frame, maybe pinned by a magnet to a refrigerator, maybe as a bookmark, maybe it was gifted to someone else who would appreciate it more, and yeah maybe some have ended up in the recycling bin. I won't know and the not knowing is okay. Art can go on its own journey independent of the person who created it.

...

Displaying artwork in the library and dispersing zines with gifted art obviously doesn't pay the bills, but there is something pure and satisfying about the work being received and experienced by others. We have ideas - a lot of ideas! - for where this experiment goes from here, but for now we'll just say thank you for reading!

-Diana

Zines are punk rock

3255 sats \ 13 comments \ @plebpoet 23 Mar BooksAndArticles #922901

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs

316 sats \ 16 comments \ @sn 14 Jul memes bot #1038881

5073 sats \ 0 replies \ @Oxbitcoiner 14 Jul



Yes, but you still keep your Bitcoin on the exchange

